BUSINESS HUB

Technical Product Requirements & Solution Brief

Version 3.0 | Partner-facing specification | October 2026

Market: Jordan • Initial customer: multi-branch F&B operators (2–20 branches)

Purpose: define exactly what the product must do, how data and workflows connect, what should run without human effort, and what requires discovery or explicit approval.

Status: product vision and preliminary requirements — not a signed engineering specification or verified regulatory integration commitment.

0. Executive decision summary

Business Hub is a multi-tenant, workflow-first operating system for growing food-and-beverage businesses. Its objective is to replace disconnected POS, accounting and HR systems while materially reducing administrative labor and owner interruptions. It must not become another dashboard requiring staff to operate multiple modules manually.

Decision	Requirement
Primary outcome	Reduce administrative hours and owner interventions per branch; preserve financial accuracy and compliance.
Initial customer	Jordanian cafés, restaurants, bakeries and QSRs operating 2–20 branches.
System end-state	Native POS, accounting, inventory/purchasing, HR/payroll, digital ordering and automation; replace Foodics, QuickBooks and ZenHR for in-scope capabilities.
Primary interfaces	Tablet POS, browser-based back office, kitchen displays, mobile-friendly employee/customer portals.
Workflow rule	Capture once → validate → post to all relevant modules → complete routine steps → escalate only exceptions.
Approvals	Policy-based auto-processing inside delegated limits; explicit approval for consequential or legally required actions.
Delivery	Phased implementation; platform-wide data and ledger integrity designed at the outset.

1. Product principles and goals

- Every feature must name the manual task, role and owner interruption it removes.
- One source transaction should drive linked inventory, financial, tax, operational and audit records.
- Straight-through processing is the default only where data is reliable and a pre-approved policy permits it.
- Exceptions should be routed to the lowest authorized role, not automatically to the owner.
- Human review is mandatory where legal requirements, safety, candidate fairness, financial materiality or low data confidence demand it.
- The system must show completed outcomes, not merely task counts; each action has evidence and a final status.
- Do not promise government, bank or aggregator API capabilities until official access and permissions are confirmed.

Non-goals for the first release: universal ERP for all industries; unrestricted autonomous bank payments; fully autonomous hiring without safeguards; replacing every external marketplace or government portal on day one.

2. Users, tenancy and operational structure

Actor	Typical capabilities
Business owner	Set policy limits; review key exceptions, financial outcomes, risk and approvals requiring owner authority.
HQ finance / accountant	Chart of accounts, period close, tax review, reconciliation, AP/AR, adjustments.
Procurement / storekeeper	Requests, purchase orders, delivery confirmation, counts, supplier exceptions.
Branch manager	Shifts, scheduling, operational exceptions, stock counts, limited approvals.
Cashier / kitchen	POS transactions, payments, kitchen tickets, order fulfillment.
HR / recruiter	Hiring workflows, employee files, attendance, payroll preparation, SSC follow-up.
Employee / candidate	Applications, interview, onboarding, leave, schedules, payslips, training.
System automation	Executes approved policies with machine identity, idempotency and audit trace.

Data must be partitioned by tenant/business and, where applicable, legal entity, branch, stock location and cost center. Employees can work at multiple branches but belong to a clearly identified legal employer. The authorization model must support HQ-wide roles, branch-limited roles and temporary delegated approvals.

3. End-to-end workflow map

Workflow ID	Trigger → verified outcome	Administrative work eliminated
WF-01 Purchase-to-Compliance	Purchase request / delivery → PO match → goods receipt → inventory valuation → AP + tax ledger → tax return inputs → archive	Repeated supplier invoice entry, stock posting, AP posting and tax preparation.
WF-02 Sale-to-Financial-Control	POS sale → payment/invoice → stock consumption → revenue/tax posting → reconciliation	Sales re-entry, recipe deductions, payment summaries and journal entry.
WF-03 Recruitment-to-Employment	Vacancy → applications → AI interview → human/policy review → documents/contract → employee setup → SSC status	Interview scheduling, repetitive screening and onboarding follow-up.
WF-04 Attendance-to-Payroll	Schedule → clock records → exception resolution → approved leave/overtime → payroll → ledger/statutory outputs	Timesheet compilation, payroll calculations and postings.
WF-05 Order-to-Fulfillment	Direct or marketplace order → shared order core → KDS → fulfillment → fee/settlement reconciliation	Channel order re-entry, kitchen routing and manual payout checks.
WF-06 Inventory-to-Replenishment	Sales/receipts/counts → available stock → reorder rules → suggested/approved PO	Manual stock monitoring and repeated order preparation.
WF-07 Transaction-to-Tax-Filing	Ledger + invoice evidence → tax validation → draft return → approval → supported filing/payment reference → archive	End-period data reconstruction and repetitive filing preparation.

4. System architecture: logical components

Proposed logical boundaries (not a mandate for microservices): Identity & Policy; Company/Branch Master Data; Product/Menu/Recipe; Order/POS; Payments & Settlement; Purchasing & Receiving; Inventory/Costing; General Ledger & Tax; Workforce/Payroll; Recruitment/AI Interview; Workflow/Notifications; Document & Audit; Reporting/Analytics; External Integration Adapters.

4.1 Transaction design

- Use stable tenant, legal entity, branch, product, supplier, employee, customer and account identifiers across all components.
- Persist a source-of-truth business event (e.g., SaleFinalized, GoodsReceiptConfirmed, PayrollFinalized) with unique idempotency key and correlation ID.
- Generate downstream records with explicit posting rules and statuses; no silent duplication on retries.
- Distinguish operational state from financial posting state and from external submission/settlement state.
- Reversals and amendments must preserve original transaction history; finalized accounting records are not silently overwritten.
- Use event-driven processing where useful, but document consistency guarantees, retry behavior, dead-letter handling and reconciliation jobs.
- Allow multi-branch consolidation and financial period locks.

4.2 Core records

Domain	Representative entities
Organization	Tenant, LegalEntity, Branch, CostCenter, User, Role, Policy, ApprovalLimit

Sales	Product, Menu, Modifier, Recipe, Order, OrderLine, Invoice, Tender, Shift, Refund, KitchenTicket
Supply chain	Supplier, PurchaseRequest, PurchaseOrder, SupplierInvoice, GoodsReceipt, StockMovement, StockCount, Wastage
Finance	ChartAccount, Journal, JournalLine, TaxCode, TaxPeriod, Payable, Receivable, BankTransaction, Settlement
People	Candidate, Interview, Evaluation, Employee, Contract, ShiftSchedule, TimeEntry, Leave, PayrollRun, Payslip
Automation	WorkflowInstance, Task, Exception, Approval, Notification, EvidenceDocument, IntegrationJob, AuditEvent

5. WF-01 Purchase-to-Compliance — detailed specification

5.1 Happy path

1. Approved purchase request generates a PO (or PO is auto-issued within delegated supplier/item/price/quantity limits).
2. Receiver captures invoice QR plus invoice image/PDF and records physically received quantities.
3. System decodes QR where possible, extracts remaining fields using OCR/document parsing and maps supplier SKUs to internal products.
4. System validates invoice uniqueness, supplier identity, tax information, PO lines, price tolerances, units and physical receipt.
5. Within approved thresholds, confirm receipt; otherwise create an exception assigned to branch/procurement/finance.
6. Post inventory quantities and valuation from accepted goods; post payable and eligible input tax based on validated invoice/accounting rules.
7. Link supplier invoice, PO, receipt, stock movements and journal lines; include eligible tax records in draft tax return.
8. Track payment approval, execution outside or inside authorized supported channels, settlement and closure.

5.2 Required controls

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
PUR-01 — QR/OCR extraction	Read available QR payload; OCR line items if missing; preserve source image, confidence score and field provenance.	Auto-extract and map recognized fields.	Low confidence, unreadable invoice or unknown supplier/product.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
PUR-02 — Three-way match	Compare PO, invoice and physically received quantity/price/unit/tax; configurable tolerances.	Straight-through post exact/in-tolerance matches.	Over-delivery, price increase, tax discrepancy, missing PO.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
PUR-03 — Duplicate prevention	Use supplier + invoice number + date/totals and government identifiers where available.	Block probable duplicate posting.	Finance resolves suspected false positives.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
PUR-04 — Financial linkage	Goods receipt, AP, tax and inventory journals use consistent source IDs and configurable accounting policies.	Post once after required validations.	Period locked, missing tax mapping, valuation mismatch.

Critical caveat: a QR code does not necessarily contain full invoice line items. Physical receipt confirmation is required before stock is recognized; invoice data alone is not proof of delivery.

6. WF-02 Sale-to-Financial-Control — detailed POS

6.1 Front-of-house capabilities

- Tablet POS: dine-in, takeaway, pickup, delivery; floor plans, tables, transfers, held orders, bill splitting.
- Products, variants, modifiers, combos, add-ons, scheduled menus, branch pricing and out-of-stock control.
- Promotions, discounts, vouchers, loyalty, gift cards, complimentary items, voids and refunds with permissions.
- Cash, card, split tender and supported digital payment methods; cashier shifts, opening float, cash drops and closing.
- Receipt/e-invoice issuance via compliant workflow, searchable transaction history and customer profile where consented.
- KDS routing by station, ticket timing/status, prioritization and ready notifications.

6.2 Sales posting rules

9. Order is captured and validated against active menu and branch availability.
10. Payment is initiated; payment authorized/captured state is stored separately from sale/order state.
11. On completion, create appropriate sales invoice and ledger postings according to configured rules.
12. Calculate theoretical recipe consumption and update relevant inventory records, with wastage/actual-count adjustments kept distinct.
13. Reconcile cash shift, terminal settlement and bank settlement; create exception for mismatch.
14. Refunds/voids reverse or adjust applicable sales, tax, inventory and payment records through explicit policies.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
POS-01 — Offline POS	Local queue for approved eligible functions, transaction IDs, secure synchronization, conflict handling and reconciliation.	Sync on reconnection with idempotency.	Connectivity-dependent payments, invoicing and external orders cannot be assumed available offline.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
POS-02 — Multi-branch control	Central catalog with branch overrides, availability and permissions.	Publish controlled changes with audit history.	Material pricing changes per delegated policy.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
POS-03 — Payment reconciliation	Match tender events, terminal settlements, bank receipts and refunds.	Auto-match reliable transactions.	Missing payout, over/under settlement, disputed charge.

7. WF-05 Order-to-Fulfillment — digital commerce

7.1 Direct ordering

- Business-branded mobile-friendly ordering channel with branch/service-area selection.
- Shared menu, modifiers, availability, pickup/delivery, delivery fees/minimums, scheduled ordering where supported.
- Guest checkout/customer accounts, eligible payment methods, order status notifications and loyalty/CRM integration.

7.2 Third-party aggregators

- Integrate supported Jordanian aggregators, prioritizing feasibility review of Talabat and Careem.
- Receive orders into one canonical order format; map menu items and modifiers; route to branch/KDS.
- Where supported, synchronize availability, prices, order acceptance and statuses.
- Track commissions, marketplace-funded vs merchant-funded promotions, refunds, delivery fees and payout statements.
- Reconcile gross sales, fees and net settlements with appropriate accounting treatment.

Each aggregator integration requires verified API access, merchant permissions, field coverage, commercial terms, sandbox/testing arrangements and settlement file availability. The platform must degrade gracefully if an aggregator API is unavailable.

8. WF-06 Inventory-to-Replenishment

- Track stock by legal entity/branch/location, units and conversions, recipes, yield and waste.
- Calculate theoretical consumption from completed sales; separate theoretical usage from physical stock counts.
- Support transfers, counts, wastage, variance analysis, costing method, expiry/batch where relevant and audit logs.
- Compute reorder points from min/max rules, lead time, forecast sales and current/committed stock.
- Generate suggested requisitions or approved supplier POs within policy limits; exceptions for price/quantity/supplier changes.
- Report ingredient/recipe costs, gross margins, actual-vs-theoretical consumption and stock losses.

9. Finance, accounting and tax engine

9.1 Native accounting scope

- General ledger, chart of accounts, journal controls, AP/AR, supplier credits, cash/bank accounts and reconciliation.
- Inventory valuation and COGS, branch/cost-center P&L, balance sheet, cash flow and consolidation.
- Source-linked journals from POS, receiving, inventory adjustments, payroll and settlement events.
- Financial close, period locking, reversal/adjustment policy, audit evidence, reporting and exports.
- Clear treatment of gross marketplace sales versus commissions, discounts, refunds and net payouts.

9.2 WF-07 Transaction-to-Tax-Filing

15. Collect sales invoices, credits, tax codes, purchase invoices and eligible input tax from source transactions.
16. Validate missing invoices, mismatched rates, duplicate records, corrections and input-tax eligibility.
17. Produce tax-period draft return, detailed working papers and exception queue.
18. Route draft to qualified finance reviewer and authorized owner/representative for filing decision.
19. If official interface permits, submit with authorized credentials; otherwise generate guided filing package and track manual completion.
20. Record official acknowledgment, payment reference, payment confirmation and archived evidence.

Jordanian tax rates, e-invoicing (JoFotara) rules, filing forms, submission methods and eFAWATEERcom payment flows require current legal/technical verification. A return may be prepared automatically, but official submission and payment cannot be assumed autonomous.

10. WF-03 Recruitment-to-Employment

21. Manager requests vacancy with branch, job, pay band, headcount and required skills; policy validates budget/headcount.
22. Generate public application link and structured applicant intake.
23. Automatically check completeness and objective job-related eligibility criteria.
24. Schedule online AI interview with explicit candidate notice and consent for recording/processing.
25. AI asks standardized role-specific questions and generates transcript, structured evidence and recommendation.
26. Configured rules progress eligible candidates; ambiguous or consequential decisions go to recruiter/hiring manager.
27. Collect documents, prepare contract, secure approval/signature, establish start date and notify stakeholders.
28. Create employee record, attendance profile, training plan and SSC preparation/submission tracking.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
HR-01 — AI interview	Configurable questions, language, evaluation rubric, recording/transcript and candidate consent.	Interview, summarize and recommend.	Human review for uncertain assessments, fairness concerns or final decisions where required.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception

HR-02 — Onboarding	Documents, contract, signatures, employee file, branch notification and training assignment.	Auto-create dependent tasks/records.	Missing paperwork, contract deviation, SSC submission issue.

Candidate data requires explicit privacy, retention, access and appeal/review controls. Do not use opaque protected-characteristic inference as a hiring criterion.

11. WF-04 Attendance-to-Payroll

11.1 Workforce records

- Legal employer, branch assignments, job/grade, contracts, compensation, employee documents and lifecycle history.
- Schedules, shift templates, swaps, time entries, break rules, lateness, overtime and attendance corrections.
- Annual/sick/other statutory and company leave; balances, accruals, approvals, certificates and scheduling impacts.
- Employee self-service for schedules, requests, payslips, documents and training.
- Training manuals, evaluation forms and progression badges linked to role eligibility and hierarchy.

11.2 Payroll sequence

29. Close payroll period and import approved schedules, attendance, leave, compensation and deductions.
30. Run configurable Jordanian statutory and contractual calculations for earnings, overtime, contributions, tax, advances and authorized deductions.
31. Flag unresolved time records, missing data, anomalous net pay and policy breaches.
32. HR reviews exceptions; finance reviews register; authorized approver finalizes payroll.
33. Generate payslips, bank instructions/files where supported and corresponding balanced ledger entries.
34. Track actual payment confirmation and applicable SSC/statutory obligations separately from payroll calculation.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
PAY-01 — Payroll engine	Versioned rules, effective dates, calculation trace and retroactive adjustment handling.	Calculate draft payroll from approved data.	Final payroll approval, payment release and legally sensitive changes.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
PAY-02 — SSC lifecycle	Prepare registrations, contribution records, changes and termination information.	Create forms/submission payloads and track statuses.	Official submission only where supported and authorized; otherwise guided workflow.

ID / capability	Expected system behavior	Automation	Human gate / exception
PAY-03 — Offboarding	Notice, leave/final pay, company assets, access removal, SSC termination and archive.	Generate checklist and calculations.	Legal/HR review of final settlement and termination.

12. Exception-driven policy and permission engine

Use role-based access control (RBAC) combined with contextual policies: legal entity, branch, category, amount, supplier, variance percentage, risk, document confidence and time. Every automation policy must be versioned, testable and reversible through controlled actions.

Risk tier	Example	Default behavior
Low / routine	Matched PO receipt under approved tolerance; standard attendance entry	Auto-process; record evidence; summarize in digest.
Medium / delegated	Small purchase variance; missing punch; candidate eligibility ambiguity	Route to branch manager/HR/finance according to ownership and SLA.

High / material	Large price change, exceptional refund, payroll finalization	Explicit designated approval; never silently execute.
Regulated / external	Tax filing, statutory submission, bank payment	Require legal authorization and verified integration; capture official acknowledgment.

12.1 Exception lifecycle

Detected → classified → assigned → notified → resolved/approved/rejected → executed/retried → verified → archived. Each exception must show reason, supporting evidence, impact, owner, deadline, available actions and escalation route. The owner sees only escalations exceeding delegated authority or material thresholds.

12.2 Owner home screen

Top panel: outcomes completed automatically (e.g., invoices posted, staff onboarded, stock reconciled). Middle panel: key business health indicators. Primary action area: a short prioritized list of decisions requiring owner authority. Never surface routine completed actions as interruptions; offer searchable detail on demand.

13. Security, reliability and operational controls

- Tenant isolation and least-privilege permissions; separation of duties for financial and HR actions.
- Encryption in transit and at rest where appropriate; secret management and strong authentication for privileged roles.
- Comprehensive audit trail: actor, policy version, original data, action, timestamp, outcome and external response.
- Backups, restore testing, disaster recovery objectives, monitoring, alerting and incident response.
- Idempotent integration retries, dead-letter queues, error dashboards and scheduled reconciliation.
- Data retention/deletion controls for candidate recordings, employee records, financial documents and customer information.
- Offline POS threat model, device enrollment, sync security and conflict resolution.
- Performance targets, load tests, localization (Arabic/English), JOD currency, time zones and receipt formats agreed in discovery.

14. Implementation strategy and MVP

Do not build every module simultaneously. Prioritize proof of administrative time saved and accounting accuracy. The native POS remains part of the committed product vision, but the technical partner should evaluate the least risky sequence for a controlled pilot.

Phase	Scope	Exit criteria
0 — Discovery (mandatory)	Current-state process mapping, customer interviews, legal/API feasibility, data mapping, architecture, baseline time/cost measurements.	Signed requirements, validated integration assumptions, backlog and budget.
1 — Shared platform	Tenancy, roles/policies, workflow engine, documents, audit, master data, accounting/event foundations.	Audited end-to-end test events and reliable exception handling.
2 — Purchase-to-Compliance pilot	PO, QR/OCR receiving, inventory, AP, tax working papers; limited pilot branch.	Verified stock/ledger reconciliation and measurable time saved.
3 — Native POS pilot	Tablet POS, menus, shifts, payments, KDS, offline sync, sales postings.	Live branch transactions reconcile to ledger and inventory.
4 — Workforce automation	Recruitment, AI interviews, employee records, attendance, leave, payroll and accounting.	Successful controlled payroll cycle and onboarding tests.
5 — Digital commerce & integrations	Direct ordering, CRM/loyalty, verified aggregator integrations and settlement.	Orders and payouts reconcile across channels.
6 — Regulatory and scale	Supported e-invoicing, tax/SSC workflows, advanced forecasting, multi-branch rollout.	Confirmed government flows, audit evidence and operational SLAs.

Exact sequencing should be approved after technical discovery; early pilots may use transitional integrations/imports where they shorten validation without undermining the long-term replacement strategy.

15. Acceptance criteria — demonstration scenarios

Test ID	Pass condition
AT-01	A matched supplier invoice scanned once results in correct stock, AP, tax draft inputs and linked evidence; no second data entry.
AT-02	A mismatched invoice is not auto-posted; the correct role receives a clear exception with PO/invoice/receipt differences.
AT-03	A POS sale creates the correct invoice, tender, revenue/tax records and recipe consumption; no duplicate entries on retry.
AT-04	A refunded order creates correct reversing/adjusting entries and retains original audit history.
AT-05	A supported marketplace order reaches the correct KDS and its commission/payout reconciles to source order data.
AT-06	Offline POS transactions sync after reconnection without duplicates or silent loss; unsupported offline actions are blocked/explained.
AT-07	An AI interview yields transcript, evidence and configured recommendation; candidate can be escalated for human review.
AT-08	Approved hire produces employee file, contract, attendance setup and tracked SSC action with no repeated personal data entry.
AT-09	Attendance and leave feed draft payroll; final payroll requires proper authorization and generates balanced journal entries.
AT-10	Tax return draft reconciles to source ledger and invoices; filing/payment remain explicitly authorized and evidenced.
AT-11	Owner sees only material decisions while routine successful automation appears in digest/reporting.
AT-12	Tenant/branch access restrictions, audit records, rollback/recovery and exception retry are demonstrated.

16. Quantifiable success metrics

Metric	Definition / proposed measurement
Straight-through processing rate	Eligible workflow instances completed without human intervention / eligible total.
Admin minutes per transaction	Time to process supplier invoice, hire, payroll exception, or tax period before vs after.
Owner interruptions	Number of owner approvals/escalations per branch per week; exclude informational digests.
Manual data-entry touches	Number of times the same transaction data is entered by a person.
Financial accuracy	Reconciliation exceptions, duplicate postings, unexplained balances and error correction rates.
Scale efficiency	Administrative FTE hours per branch and per 1,000 transactions as branch count grows.
Time to completion	Median purchase-to-post, candidate-to-onboard, payroll-close and tax-preparation times.
Exception quality	False-positive alerts, mean resolution time and percentage resolved below owner level.

Set baselines with pilot customers before choosing numeric targets. No headcount reduction or savings amount should be represented as guaranteed without evidence.

17. Technical partner deliverables and open decisions

17.1 Required deliverables

35. Product requirements document (PRD) with requirement IDs, priorities, user stories and edge cases.
36. System context and component architecture diagrams; data model and ownership boundaries.
37. Sequence diagrams for all seven workflows, including failure and reversal paths.
38. RBAC/policy matrix, approval thresholds, escalation routes and audit design.
39. Accounting posting matrix for every source event, including refunds, partial receipts, tax and payroll.
40. Integration feasibility matrix: JoFotara, sales tax, SSC, eFAWATEERcom, terminals, Talabat/Careem, banks and hardware.
41. Offline POS design, sync consistency guarantees and device compatibility plan.
42. Security/privacy design, backup/recovery plan and compliance review requirements.
43. MVP backlog, dependency graph, staffing plan, milestone estimates, budget and operating cost forecast.
44. Migration plan from Foodics, QuickBooks and ZenHR with test reconciliation and rollback.
45. Automated test plan, UAT scripts, acceptance metrics, release/support and monitoring plan.

17.2 Open questions to validate

- Official government API availability and legally permitted filing/payment automation in Jordan.
- Supplier invoice QR payload consistency and OCR extraction accuracy for local suppliers.
- Aggregator commercial/API access, settlement data coverage and terminal provider support.
- Payroll and statutory rules, employer structures, accounting standards and tax treatment.
- Exact offline POS scope, supported hardware, receipt/e-invoice behavior and reconciliation.
- Hosting, security requirements, customer data residency, pricing model and deployment budget.
- Migration history requirements and whether a limited transitional integration is needed during pilot.

18. Final engineering mandate

Build Business Hub as an outcome engine with a single coherent data foundation. Every workflow must be capable of completing routine steps autonomously, explaining its decisions, escalating exceptions to the appropriate role, and proving that the operational and financial outcomes are correct. The owner must not become the bottleneck for processes that can safely run under pre-approved policies.

Engineering definition of done: the user completes the real-world business action once; all linked modules reach a verified consistent state; failures are visible and recoverable; approvals are appropriate; the evidence is archived; and administrative effort measurably decreases.